

RAILWAYS
OF THE
LOST
ATLAS

SOLO MODE

SETUP

MAP BUILDING

Choose a pre-set Short Game map to play on or build a map using the Short Game with Randomized Minors variant.

COMPANY SELECTION

Form the Conglomerate by revealing one Minor Company at random from those included in the map and choosing which other Minor Company on the map to pair it with.

INITIAL CONGLOMERATE SETUP

The Conglomerate Corporation is formed by merging the two Companies you selected under the Conglomerate charter (*or another Major charter of your choice*). Place two hub tokens on the 60 spots of the charter. Place six Major shares (*including the president's certificate*) in the Conglomerate treasury. Place three single Major shares below the merged charter, these shares are not considered to be in the Conglomerate's treasury. Place the final single Major share in the bank pool. Shuffle all stock certificates of the Minor Companies chosen for the Conglomerate and place them in a face-up pile near the Conglomerate charter to form the Action Deck. Place 450 in the Conglomerate treasury, this treasury is shared between both the Conglomerate as a player and the Conglomerate as a Corporation. Whenever the Conglomerate would gain or spend money it goes into or comes from the Conglomerate treasury.

The Conglomerate starts the game with an established route on the map. Place yellow track tiles to connect the two merged Minor Company homes using the following guidelines:

- Yellow track on home tiles should be placed such that one leg is pointing towards the shortest path to the other home tile. The other open leg is pointed towards the closest hex that is a Capital city, unlaunched Minor Company home, or Distant Destination (*closest is determined using the number of tiles needed to reach the location*). Ties for closest are broken in the order listed. If there is still a tie you choose between the tied locations.
- Connect both home tiles using yellow track. When there is a choice between tiles that are of equal distance, select the tile on which to lay track using the following order of priority: Capital city, unlaunched Minor Company home, basic city, blank hex, mountain hex.
- All mountain hex costs are paid from the Conglomerate treasury
- The Conglomerate stock price is the sum of all city revenue that is included in their initial network. If the total is below 60, the stock price is 60. If the total is above 90, the stock price is 90.
- Place a hub token from each included Minor Company in their home spot with a Conglomerate hub token on top of them. These will be used to guide actions during Operating Rounds.

- In the unlikely event that a connection is not possible, bridges are used on intervening water hexes to connect the two home spots.

A NOTE ON DIFFICULTY

The Conglomerate's Initial network value is a general indicator of difficulty.

40-60 = Easy
70-90 = Medium
100+ = Hard

Proximity to Capitals and unlaunched Minors also affect difficulty. Sometimes a higher initial network value with less access to Capitals and unlaunched Minors is easier than a low price that can become well connected. (*see Diagrams*)

PLAYER SETUP

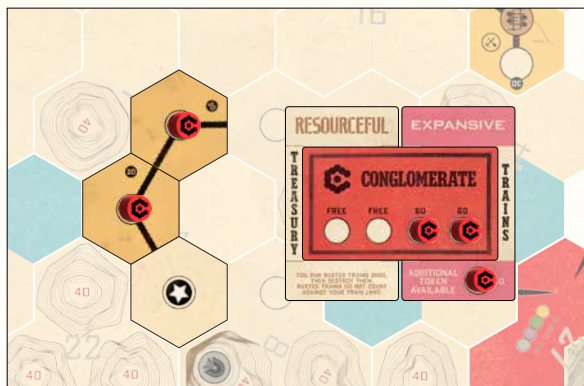
Take 450 starting capital from the bank.

AUCTION MATRIX SETUP

Shuffle the remaining six Minor Company charters and deal them into two columns, each with three charters.

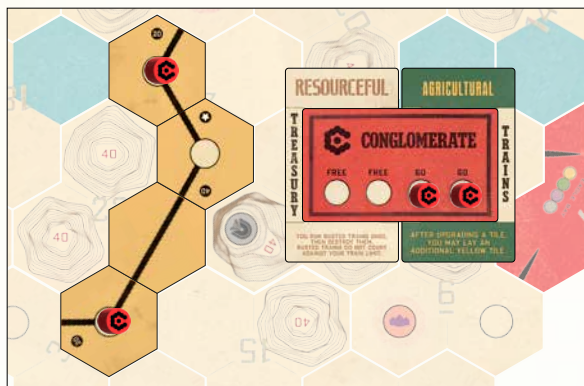
REMAINING COMPONENTS

Setup all remaining components according to the standard Short Game setup rules.



EASY SETUP

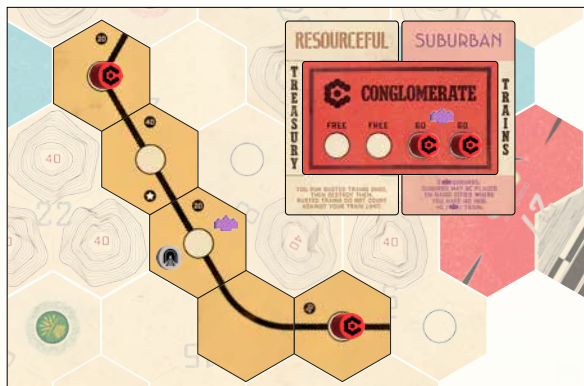
Conglomerate Initial Stock Value = 60



MEDIUM SETUP

Conglomerate Initial Stock Value = 80

The Conglomerate will place a hub token on the Capital in its first Operating Round.



HARD SETUP

Conglomerate Initial Stock Value = 90

The Conglomerate will place a hub token on the Capital in its first Operating Round and will absorb Tunneling if it is unlaunched in the first available Merger Round.

SPECIAL SETUP RULES BY COMPANY

The following Companies have special setup rules when they are included in the Conglomerate:



Adaptive Company

Home placement when included in the Conglomerate is decided relative to the other included Minor Company's home location. Find the nearest Capital city to that home and place Adaptive's token in the nearest basic city on the opposite side of that Capital. This Capital must be included in the initial track connection (*Connect each Minor to the Capital rather than directly to each other*)



Expansive Company

Place an Expansive token under the Conglomerate token in the 40 spot of the charter.



Suburban Company

If there are non-hub basic cities included in the initial track connection, place suburb tokens on them in order starting with the closest to Suburban's home. Suburb tokens are included when calculating initial stock price.



Bridging Company

Water hexes are considered blank when prioritizing initial track lays as long as the bridge that is needed is still in the Conglomerate's supply. Use the appropriate bridge to make a connection. If there is a choice between a water hex and a blank hex the blank hex is chosen to preserve bridge tiles.



Tunneling Company

The Conglomerate gains 20 for each mountain covered during initial track lays. Mountain hexes are chosen over blank hexes when prioritizing initial track lays.

STOCK ROUNDS

PLAYER RULES

You always have the Priority Player Marker.

Conglomerate shares may only be purchased from the Bank Pool.

Note: In the first Stock Round the Conglomerate has not operated yet so its shares cannot be sold during that round.

You may not sell shares of a Company you are the president of if that sale would transfer the presidency to the Conglomerate.

When you launch an auction for a Minor Company, you win the auction at your initial bid and launch the Company as normal.

All other Stock Round rules apply.

CONGLOMERATE RULES

The Conglomerate will always purchase one share of any launched Company or Corporation (*owned by you*) it does not already own a share of, provided it has the funds to do so in its treasury. These shares are kept in and pay dividends to the Conglomerate treasury. Corporation shares are purchased from the bank pool if possible.

The Conglomerate will sell any non-Conglomerate share that is above the highest initial stock price of the current phase (*100+ in Yellow, 120+ in Green, and 150+ in Purple and Gray*).

No other actions are taken by the Conglomerate in Stock Rounds. All of the normal stock buying and selling rules still apply.

OPERATING ROUNDS

PLAYER RULES

There are no changes to your actions compared to the standard game.

CONGLOMERATE RULES

At the start of Operating Round 1 in each of the first three cycles, the Conglomerate issues to the bank pool one of the three shares that were placed below the charter during setup. The Conglomerate receives the current stock value and the stock price drops one increment.

The Conglomerate always purchases one train each Operating Round, before taking Operating Round actions. It pays the difference in price between the current available train and the last train it purchased (*if the current available train is the same rank as the last train purchased, the Conglomerate pays 0*). The Conglomerate has no train limit and its trains do not rust. Keep them in a single stack with the last purchased train on top. In the unlikely event that the Conglomerate cannot afford the current available train, it does not purchase a train but still generates revenue using the top train of its stack.

The Conglomerate takes Operating Round actions driven by the Action Deck that was created during setup. Actions that refer to home or proximity use the hub token that includes that Company's home as the origin. At the start of each Operating Round remove the top card of the Action Deck and set it aside as the current action. This will reveal the action for the next Operating Round as well. There are two types

of actions based on the number of Company symbols pictured on the current Action Certificate. Single shares prompt basic actions, president's shares prompt special actions. All upgrades performed by the Conglomerate ignore phase restrictions. Open legs are pointed towards the nearest revenue generator if possible unless otherwise noted.

(See back cover for exceptions and special actions table)

The basic action is an expansion of the current network with two yellow tiles. The Conglomerate always builds track towards the nearest city/Distant Destination, prioritizing them as follows:

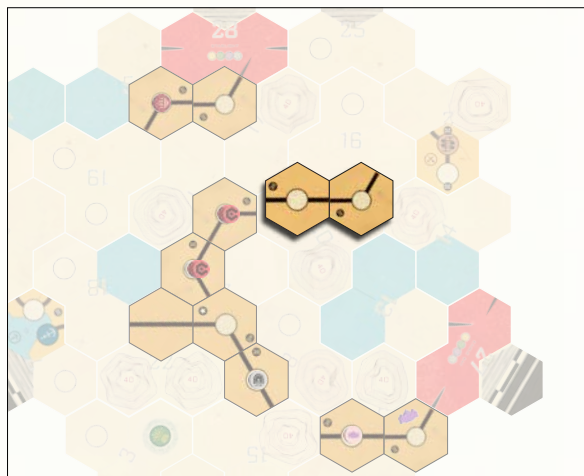
Capital City

- ↳ Unlaunched Minor home
- ↳ Home of one of your Companies
- ↳ Distant Destination
- ↳ Basic city

Any open legs after laying track should be pointed according to the same prioritization. It will only take this action if it has an open path to connect to the targeted location. It will not build track towards empty edges of track tiles that are already on the board. If the Conglomerate has no viable locations to target, it instead upgrades the corresponding home tile. If it is unable to upgrade its home tile due to track laying restrictions, it instead upgrades the nearest city (*remember, the Conglomerate ignores phase restrictions on upgrades*).

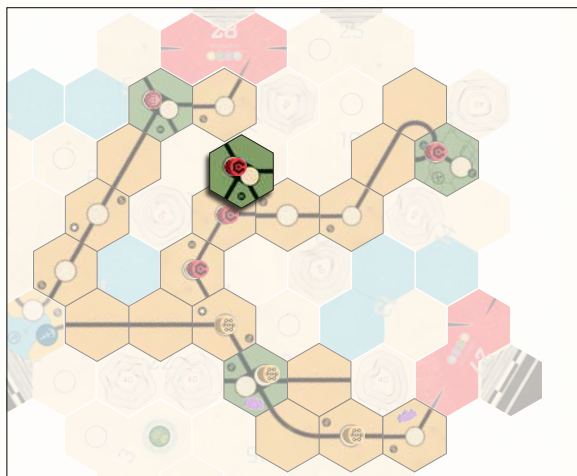
OPERATING ROUNDS

When a president's certificate is activated from the Action Deck the Conglomerate takes the special action listed in the Action Table. If the action cannot be performed, the Conglomerate instead takes a basic action. After an action is performed from a president's certificate, regardless of which action was performed, the Conglomerate purchases an additional train.



BASIC ACTION

Tiles are laid on nearest revenue generators with open leg pointing to the shortest path to an unlaunched Minor home spot.

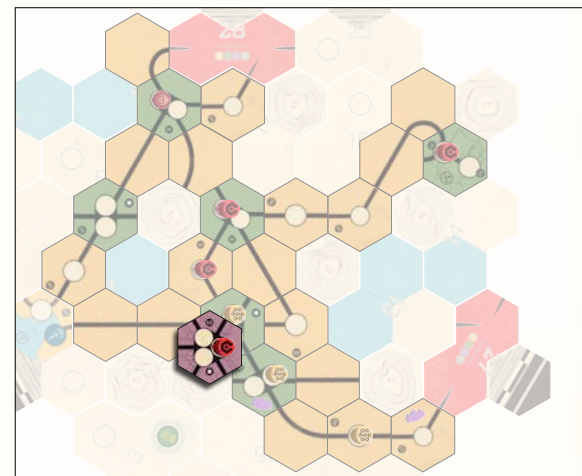


ALTERNATE BASIC ACTION

No yellow tiles can be placed so the Conglomerate upgrades the associated home tile (*Expansive*). Open legs are pointed towards nearest accessible revenue generators.

“BREAKTHROUGH”

If there is a network the Conglomerate is not connected to, and there is at least one pair of track and/or city tiles (*adjacent to each other*) that could be upgraded to make a connection between the Conglomerate network and your network, the Conglomerate upgrades the nearest valid tile or pair of tiles to make the connection. If there is more than one network that meets this criteria, the Conglomerate chooses the network with the most Capital tiles, then the most unlaunched Minor Company home tiles, then the most total cities. The Conglomerate does not lay any yellow tiles for this purpose.



BREAKTHROUGH EXAMPLE

The Conglomerate is one upgrade away from two separate player networks. Each Network has a Capital, but the lower network has an unlaunched Minor Company. The Conglomerate upgrades the Capital tile and will immediately place a hub token on it. Both placements of the new leg allow access so the player decides how to connect the tile.

OPERATING ROUNDS

If the Conglomerate is connected to a Capital City with an open token slot it places a hub token there immediately, paying the cost from its treasury.

Conglomerate earnings are calculated using a static formula instead of tracing routes. The Conglomerate gains revenue from a number of cities (*including Distant Destinations*) it can trace a route to, which is equal to its current train value times the number of hubs it has on the map. Cities are counted from most to least valuable and cities with Conglomerate hubs are counted twice (*and count as two cities*) before moving to the next most valuable city in the Conglomerate network.

(see Diagram)

The Conglomerate always pays out to shareholders.



The Conglomerate has a 3-train on top of its stack and three hub tokens on the map so it will run the 9 highest revenue cities in its network.

Cities with hubs are counted twice so this run will hit all cities in the Conglomerate's network.

3 hubs x 3 train = 9 count

1.	Mining tile	50
2.	Mining Hub (30)	30
3.	Mining Hub (30)	30
4.	Expansive Hub (20)	20
5.	Expansive Hub (20)	20
6.	Resourceful Hub (20)	20
7.	Resourceful Hub (20)	20
8.	Basic City	20
9.	+ Basic City	20
Total Earnings		230

The Conglomerate pays out 23 per share.

MERGER ROUND

PLAYER RULES

There are no changes from the standard rules.

CONGLOMERATE RULES

If the Conglomerate has a hub token available, and it is connected to an unlaunched Minor home spot, it absorbs that Minor. Place a Conglomerate hub token on top of the Minor token in a city spot on the home tile (*at no cost to the Conglomerate*). Shuffle all stock certificates from that Company into the remaining Action Deck (*this may change the action for the next Operating Round*). Place the charter for the absorbed Minor Company near the Conglomerate charter.

The Conglomerate stock price moves up by one increment.

EXPORT A TRAIN

There is no train export in the solo mode.

END OF GAME

The game ends after the fourth cycle. Scores are determined by summing all cash on hand and the value of all shares held. The Conglomerate scores all cash and shares in its treasury while you only score cash and shares in your personal holdings.

Special thanks to David Digby, Sean Blanton, Michael Bevilacqua and anyone who playtested and provided feedback for their contributions to this variant.

COMPANY SPECIFIC EXCEPTIONS & ACTIONS

COMPANY	OPERATING ROUND EXCEPTION OR ADDITION	SPECIAL ACTION
ADAPTIVE	None	Breakthrough
AGRICULTURAL	The Conglomerate places a yellow tile after any upgrade using Basic Action rules.	Breakthrough <i>(then lay a yellow tile for each upgrade that was placed)</i>
BRIDGING	When laying yellow track tiles, the Conglomerate treats water hexes as if they were blank as long as the appropriate bridge tile is available. If there is a choice between a water hex and a blank hex the blank hex is chosen to preserve bridge tiles. When upgrading city tiles, the Conglomerate points as many track edges as possible into water.	Breakthrough
EASTERN MINING	None	Breakthrough
EXPANSIVE	The Conglomerate prioritizes placing the hub tokens from the 60 spots on its charter before placing the Expansive token from the 40 spot.	If the Expansive special hub token is not placed yet, place it in the nearest basic city, paying 40. Upgrade all cities that contain Expansive hubs.
EXPRESS	None	Breakthrough
NORTHERN PORT	None	Upgrade the ⚓ tile to Purple.
OVERNIGHT	When calculating revenue, the Conglomerate ignores any cities in its network that are fully tokened by your Companies or Corporations. They are considered open with a revenue of 0.	Breakthrough
RESOURCEFUL	None	Breakthrough
SPACIOUS	None	The Conglomerate purchases an additional train before calculating revenue.
SUBURBAN	Each Operating Round, after taking an action, if any 🏠 tokens remain on the Conglomerate's charter, it places one on the nearest basic city <i>(with no Conglomerate hub token)</i> it is connected to that does not have a 🏠 token. If there are none, check again next Operating Round.	Upgrade all cities that have a suburb token. Suburbs count as +20 this Operating Round.
TUNNELING	When laying yellow track tiles, the Conglomerate prioritizes mountain hexes over blank hexes.	Place one Mountain overlay tile on the blank hex closest to each open leg in any network that contains hubs of Companies or Corporations you control. You decide ties.